



Q2-26: Stronger BEV demand positive for chargers

Further elevated charging demand expected

The European EV market is showing substantial shifts in both adoption rates and charging demand patterns. Recent analysis indicates a strengthening of charging demand that does not seem to follow typical seasonality. This initial surge suggests a higher utilization of the existing BEV fleet, potentially influenced by external factors like elevated oil prices. At the same time, new BEV registrations in key European markets are now showing significant upward momentum, outpacing the general automotive sector. These trends collectively point towards sustained growth in overall charging demand, creating a favorable environment for charging point operators and the broader EV infrastructure supply chain. We anticipate further clarity and detailed insights from upcoming financial disclosures by Fastned and Alfen in August.

Developments in EU charging infrastructure: Build rate down y/y

By the end of Q2, the EU had 1,170k public charging points, up 18% y/y and 4% sequentially. The quarterly build rate came in slightly lower than the five year average at 45k units, down 20% y/y and 20k lower than in Q1. Assuming the average build rate of the past years leads us to a charging network of 1,267k by the end of 2026. According to the AFIR regulation and the focus on power output, the EAFO website indicates that almost all member states are fulfilling the specific targets (see [here](#)). Meanwhile, the DC share increased sequentially again by 30bps to 18.9% (vs. 16.8% in Q2-25).

Developments in the top-five countries: Growth across the board with Germany falling behind EU growth rate

According to EAFO data, the charging network in the top-five European countries (Germany, France, UK, Italy, Spain) grew further in Q2. Italy and Spain outperformed the EU market with 21% and 20% y/y, respectively. France and the UK developed in line with the wider market, while Germany fell behind with a growth rate of 14% y/y. We do note that Germany was outperforming the market in Q1, hence indicating the well-known volatility in the charging construction industry. In line with the ongoing trend, the DC shares of the EU5 countries remain above EU average, with Spain leading the list (27%).

Ratio of EVs per charging point: Another uptick among all EU5

Among the top-five countries, the EV-per-charger ratio sequentially increased

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across all EU5 countries. The UK continues to have the highest ratio among the EU5 with 28.8x, a number which is rising since Q2-22. The country is struggling with grid congestion hampering the roll out of a dense charging network. Italy remains the country with the lowest ratio with 12.2x, sequentially up from 11.4x. Overall, the countries need to ensure the stability of the grid system and the reduction of barriers to ease investments.

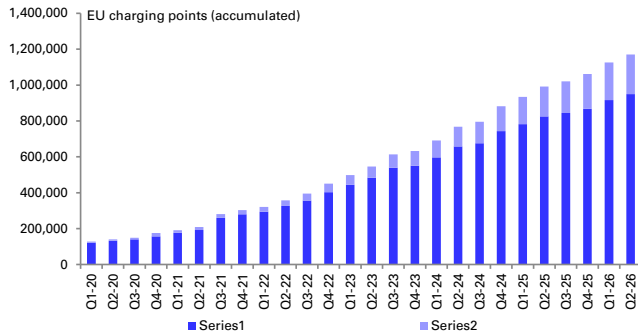
Q2 hot topic - Stronger BEV sales leading to even more charging demand?

Fastned's Q1 reporting indicated stronger charging demand, contrary to typical seasonality (see our note [here](#)). As BEV demand wasn't significantly outperforming the market back then, we attributed this to increased utilization of the existing BEV fleet amidst higher oil prices (see our note [here](#)). This was primarily due to the typical three-month order-to-registration lag. However, June figures show initial upticks in BEV registrations in EU5 countries, outperforming the overall market by 50ppts in June, potentially linked to elevated oil prices (see our note [here](#)). Consequently, we anticipate further increases in charging demand, benefiting charging point operators like Fastned and construction supply chain companies such as Alfen. We expect more insights during Q2 reporting, with Fastned publishing its figures on August 13th and Alfen on August 18th (see our previews [here](#) and [here](#)).



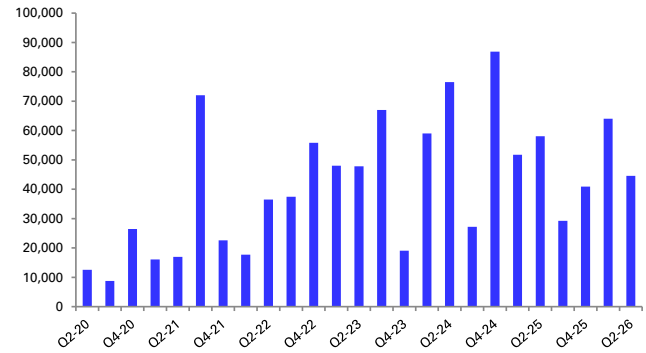
Key charts

Figure 1: In Europe, the public charging network growth is ongoing at a lower pace y/y...



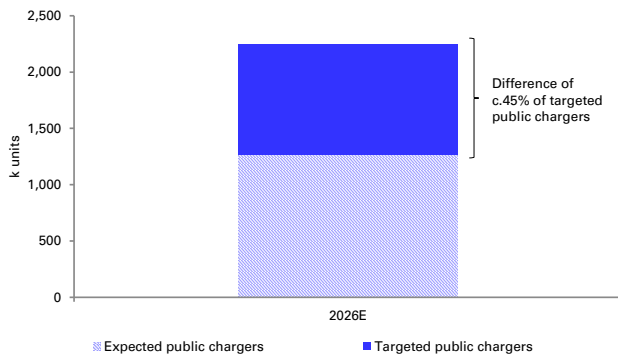
Source : Deutsche Bank, EAFO

Figure 2: ...with Q2 build rate also lower sequentially



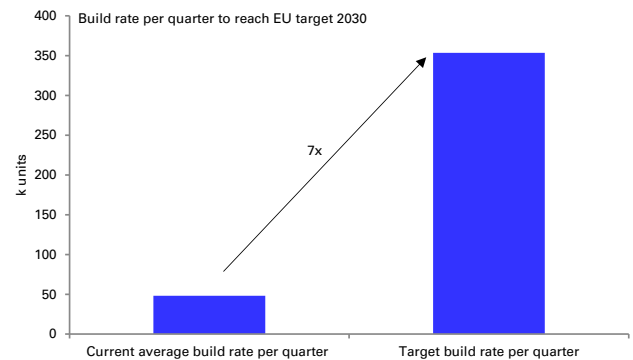
Source : Deutsche Bank, EAFO

Figure 3: The gap between required and expected chargers remains constantly high...



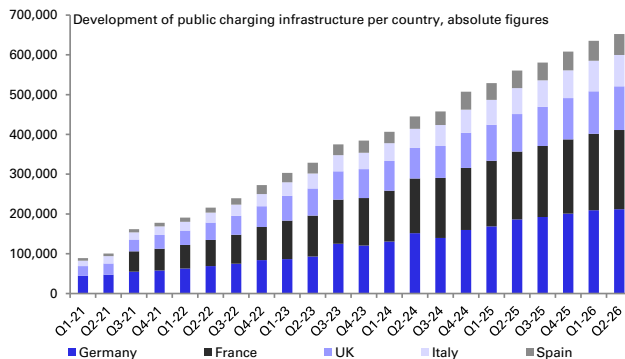
Source : Deutsche Bank estimates, EAFO

Figure 4: ...necessitating a 7x increase in the build rate despite a lower target by 2030



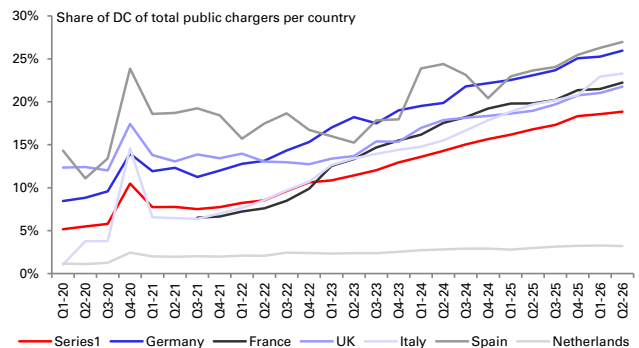
Source : Deutsche Bank estimates, EAFO

Figure 5: The top-five countries are showing different growth paths, with Italy growing the most strongly...



Source : Deutsche Bank, EAFO

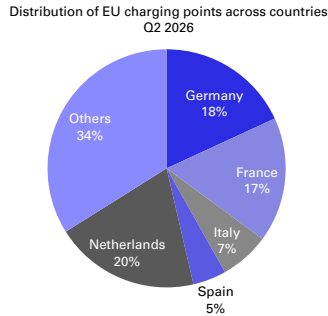
Figure 6: ...while DC share is rising further, remaining above the European average



Source : Deutsche Bank, EAFO

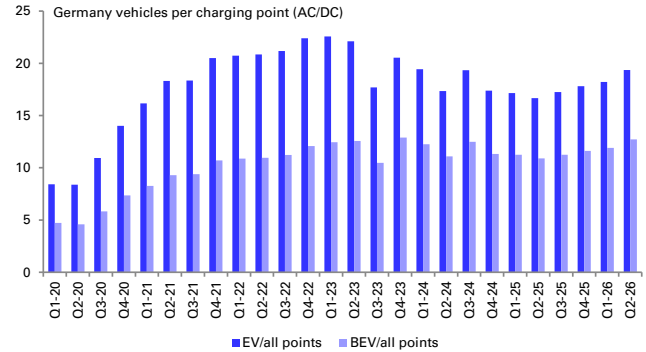


Figure 7: Distribution of chargers across Europe shows relatively stable distribution among the countries



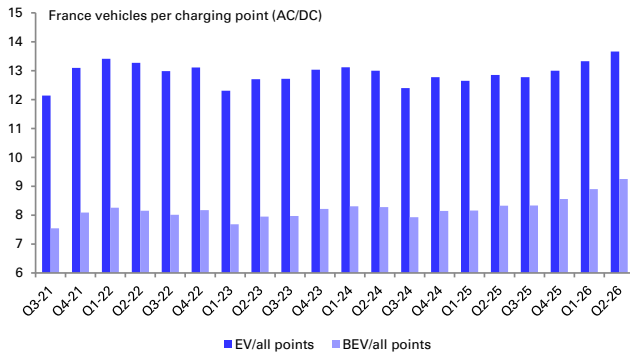
Source : Deutsche Bank, EAFO

Figure 8: Germany shows a slight sequential increase in (B)EV-per-charger ratio again...



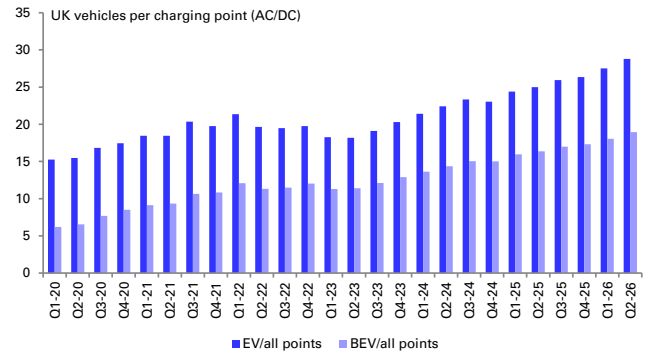
Source : Deutsche Bank, EAFO, KBA

Figure 9: ...similar to France...



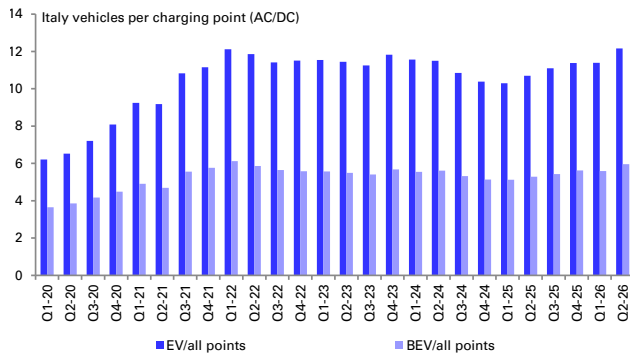
Source : Deutsche Bank estimates, EAFO, CCFA

Figure 10: ...and the UK



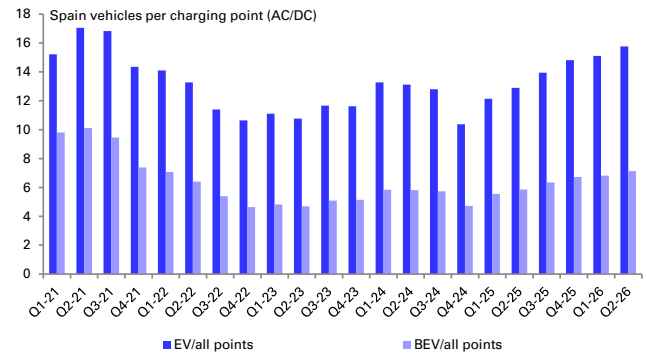
Source : Deutsche Bank estimates, EAFO, UK gov, SMMT

Figure 11: Italy's ratio rose as well q/q...



Source : Deutsche Bank estimates, EAFO, ANFIA

Figure 12: ...similar to Spain but at a higher level



Source : Deutsche Bank estimates, EAFO, ANFAC



Appendix 1

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23 July 2026

Auto Parts

inCharge

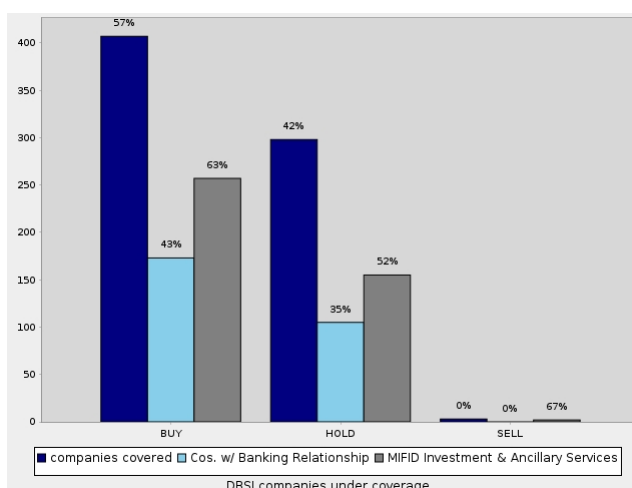
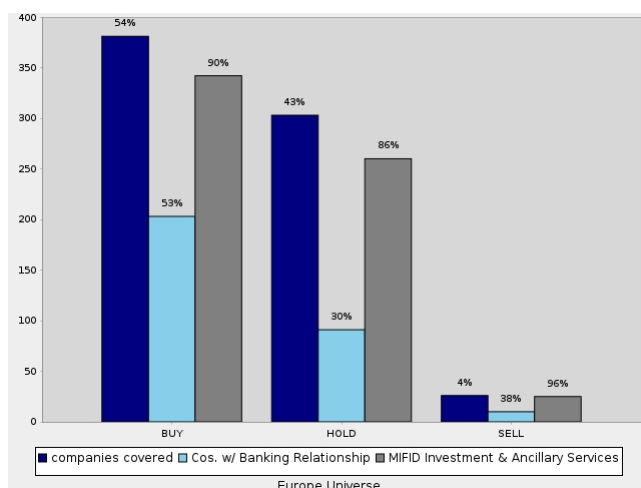


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